Employee listening: user guide

Who this is for: everyone who uses the employee listening module of NestSelf. Each section is for one role. Find yours, follow the numbered steps, and read "What the states mean" when a screen shows a word you do not recognise. People, organisations and numbers in this guide are fictional.

What the module does, in one paragraph: every two weeks your organisation can ask its people five short questions about the past two weeks. Answers are voluntary and private. The employer sees only group results, in fixed colour bands, for groups of at least ten people. When a result is red, the employer can ask NestSelf for a human workplace review, which is scoped, priced and accepted explicitly before any work starts. Separately, every employee can raise a problem or a suggestion that reaches a named recipient without the employer learning who sent it.

For employees

Answer a survey

1. You receive an email saying your organisation opened a survey, or you see **Survey** in the menu. Open it.
2. Read **Before you start**. It says who asks, that taking part is voluntary, that your employer sees only aggregate results for groups of at least ten people, and what NestSelf keeps (a restricted technical link to your account, used only to check eligibility, avoid duplicate answers, send at most two reminders and show your receipt). Press **Read the full notice** for the complete text.
3. Press **Start the survey**. There are five questions, one per screen, each rated 1 to 5. The scale explains what 1 and 5 mean.
4. Rate a question, or press **Skip this question**. Your answers save privately as you go ("Saved" appears); you can leave and come back while the survey is open.
5. Press **Next** until **Review your answers**. Change anything you like, then press **Submit**. You need at least one rating to submit.
6. **Thank you** confirms the date. Your answers are counted once and cannot be changed afterwards.

If something fails: "Could not save" means a draft did not reach the server; press **Try again**. If the survey closed while you were answering, you are told so and nothing is counted.

Raise a problem or a suggestion

1. Open **Feedback** in the menu, or press **Share feedback separately** on the survey receipt. Opening the form creates nothing.
2. Choose **Problem** or **Suggestion**, then a **Category**.
3. Under **Who should receive it?** the form names the designated recipient and an alternative. Choose the alternative when the matter concerns the designated recipient. The preview tells you who receives the report and that the other person is not told you chose the alternative.
4. **Report without my name** is on by default: the recipient sees a case pseudonym such as `Reporter-K7PQ`, never your account. You can switch it off if you want your name to travel with the report.
5. Write what happened or what would help, up to 5000 characters. Details in your text can still reveal who you are; share what the recipient needs and no more.

6. Press **Send report**. The receipt shows the case pseudonym, the recipient's function and the response target.

Follow a case

1. Open **Feedback**. Each case shows its pseudonym and state.
2. Open a case to read the conversation. You see the recipient's replies to you; you never see their internal notes.
3. Reply in the box at the bottom when the recipient asks a question or when you have more to add. A reply on a resolved case reopens it.
4. You are notified by email when there is a reply. The email never contains the content.

What the states mean: **Submitted** (received, not yet read), **In review** (the recipient is working on it), **Waiting for you** (they asked you something), **Action in progress** (something is being done), **Resolved** (the recipient explained the outcome), **Closed** (finished; a reply still reopens it).

For the survey administrator (HR)

You hold the "Survey administrator" permission. You schedule cycles and read the rules. You never see who answered.

Schedule a cycle

1. Open **Surveys** in the menu. The screen shows the rules NestSelf configured with you: how often, how long each cycle is open, how many reminders, which questionnaire version, and the next automatic launch.
2. Press **Schedule a cycle**. Choose when it opens, or press **Open it now**. The screen shows when it will close.
3. Press **Schedule**. The cycle appears in the table with its state and a count of how many active members would be invited. Invitations go out when it opens.
4. To stop a cycle, press **Cancel cycle** and confirm. Collection and reminders stop and no partial result is published. A published cycle cannot be cancelled.

What the states mean: **Scheduled** (waiting for its opening date), **Open** (collecting answers), **Closing** (closed, results being computed), **Published** (results available), **Canceled**, **Failed** (NestSelf is told and retries; nothing is lost).

Read the rules

Open **Listening** and then **Settings** to see which capabilities are enabled (measurement, feedback, workplace reviews), the colour thresholds, the minimum group size and the freshness window. Only NestSelf changes them, and a change affects future cycles only.

For reporting users (HR, owners, managers with a reporting grant)

Read the overview

1. Open **Listening**. Five cards show the latest published result for the whole organisation: the favourable percentage, a colour band and its text (**Good**, **Monitor**, **Needs attention**), the change since the previous cycle when the questionnaire is comparable, and how many people answered.
2. A gray card says why there is no score: **Collecting** (a survey is open), **Not measured**, **Not enough responses** or **Hidden to protect confidentiality**. **Outdated** means the latest result is older than the freshness window; it stays for reference.
3. The overview never shows a live score while a survey is open, and never names a respondent.

Compare departments

1. Press **Compare departments** or open **Listening > Departments**.
2. Each row is the whole organisation or a department; each column a dimension. A cell shows the percentage and the band, or **Hidden** when fewer than the minimum number of people answered that question there. A department is also hidden when showing it would reveal a smaller one.
3. Press a cell for the dimension's detail: the definition, the series over cycles and the distribution of favourable, neutral and unfavourable answers.

Export

Press **Export CSV** on the overview if you hold the export permission. You confirm your identity once (a code or your authenticator), and the file contains the same cells, bands and hidden values as the screen. The export is recorded.

The review offer

When a dimension is red and the result is current, the overview offers a human workplace review. It is an invitation, not a booking: nothing is bought, scheduled or sent to anyone until you make a request. Press **Not now** to hide the offer for this result.

For the review requester and the approver

Two permissions: "Workplace review requester" asks for and follows a review; "Workplace review approver" accepts the price, within a spending limit set when the permission was granted. One person may hold both.

Request a workplace review

1. Open **Listening > Workplace reviews** and press **Request a review**, or press the offer on the overview.
2. The form shows the result it concerns, the dimensions to look at and the service from the catalogue. A service without a configured price says **Request a quote**; the platform never invents a number.
3. Read the box that explains the difference: a request starts a conversation. NestSelf triages it within two working days, may ask questions, and then sends a scope with a price. Only an approver's acceptance of that scope starts paid work.

4. Decide whether to **Share the aggregate results with the reviewer**. Only the protected result you see, with the same hidden cells, is ever shared; never answers, names or feedback cases. You can withdraw the sharing later.
5. Add context if useful, tick the terms, and press **Send request**. The receipt confirms the state. A second request for the same scope is answered with the existing one.

Answer questions and accept a scope

1. Open the request from **Workplace reviews**. The coordinator's name and the state are at the top.
2. If NestSelf asks for information (**Needs information**), answer in the box and press **Send answer**.
3. When a scope arrives (**Scoped**), it lists what is delivered, who takes part, the price, tax note, validity and cancellation policy. Each version is numbered; an older version is marked **Superseded**.
4. An approver presses **Accept scope**, confirms their identity, and confirms. Accepting binds this version and its price under the organisation's commercial authority; no payment is taken in the platform. A requester without that authority sees "Only an approver with the right spending authority can accept a scope."
5. **Decline scope** tells NestSelf the scope does not fit; a new version may follow.
6. **Cancel request** withdraws a request that has not been accepted.

What the states mean: **Submitted**, **Needs information**, **In review**, **Scoped** (a scope awaits your decision), **Accepted** (an engagement exists), **Declined** (NestSelf gave a reason), **Canceled**.

Follow the engagement

1. Open the engagement from the request or from **Workplace reviews**. It shows the accepted scope, the reviewer's first name and the coordinator.
2. **Meeting**: when NestSelf proposes times, choose one (times are shown in your organisation's zone and your own) and press **Book this time**. Both participants receive a calendar invitation. "That time is no longer available" means the reviewer was booked meanwhile; choose another.
3. **Sharing**: share the current result with the reviewer, or withdraw a sharing. Withdrawing closes the reviewer's access at once.
4. **Report**: the reviewer's report appears here only after the reviewer shares it, as the version they released. Later edits create a new version; the shared one does not change.
5. **Agreed actions**: the reviewer proposes actions; you agree, start, complete or mark them as not proceeding, and you can add your own. An action's status never changes a survey score.
6. **Follow-up**: the planned date and owner, when the reviewer set one.
7. **Cancel engagement** cancels the meeting and ends the reviewer's access under the accepted cancellation policy. The organisation's results do not change.

What the states mean: **Accepted** (waiting for a reviewer and a time), **Scheduled** (meeting booked), **In progress**, **Report shared**, **Follow-up**, **Completed**, **Canceled**. Completion is independent of the survey colour: an area may stay red.

For the feedback recipient (handler)

You were named as the designated or the alternative recipient of your organisation's feedback channel.

1. Open **Feedback inbox**. Each case shows its pseudonym, category, state, next action and whether its response target has passed.
2. Open a case. The conversation shows what the reporter wrote. You never see who they are, and you must not try to find out from the text.
3. **Reply** sends a message the reporter reads. **Internal note** (switch it on before sending) is visible only to recipients of this case, never to the reporter.
4. Change the state as the case moves: **In review**, **Waiting for reporter**, **Action in progress**, **Resolved** (write the explanation the reporter will read), **Closed**.
5. **Hand over** moves the case to the other recipient of the route when you cannot take it. A case the reporter sent to the alternative recipient is never handed to the designated one.
6. A case that passes its response target is escalated automatically: from the designated recipient to the alternative, never the other way. You are reminded by email; the email carries no content.

For the employer owner: configure recipients

1. Open **Settings** and find **Feedback recipients**.
2. Choose the designated recipient and an independent alternative for the standard channel, and the response target in hours. Both must be active members with the "Feedback handler" permission, and they cannot be the same person.
3. Save. Open cases keep their current recipient; new reports follow the new routes.
4. The sensitive channel appears only once NestSelf enabled it for your organisation, which requires a staffed process on your side (recipients, operating hours, response target, escalation).

For NestSelf: listening administrator

Configure a client

1. Open **Organizations**, choose the client, then the **Listening** tab. Confirm your identity when asked.
2. Enable each capability with its own dates: measurement, feedback, workplace reviews. A capability outside its window is off; the client's screens say so.
3. Set the cadence (days between cycles), the response window, the reminder limit, the freshness window, the minimum group size (never below the platform floor of 10), the two colour thresholds, the questionnaire version (published versions only) and the next launch.
4. Save. Only changed fields are sent; the rules get a new version number, and the client's next cycle uses it. Open cycles keep the version they launched with.

Maintain the questionnaire

1. Open **Questionnaires**. Version 1 is the pilot's five positively keyed questions.
2. **New draft** copies the latest published wording. Edit the question, the scale labels and the notice in all four languages; **Fill Cyrillic from Latin** transliterates the Serbian Latin text.

3. **Submit for review**, then a content publisher presses **Publish** and confirms their identity. A published version is immutable; cycles copy it, and a new version is comparable with the previous one only if you say so.
4. **Archive** retires a version from new cycles.

For NestSelf: review coordinator

1. Open **Review requests**. The queue shows every request with its organisation, scope, dimensions, state, requester's first name, coordinator, request date and response target. **Overdue** and **Unassigned** are flagged.
2. Open a request. Read the context the requester gave and whether they agreed to share results with the reviewer.
3. **Triage**: take it in review, ask for information (write what you need; the requester reads it), or decline (write the reason the requester reads). Press **Apply**.
4. **Send a scope**: pick the service from the catalogue, write the title, deliverables and participants, enter the price in cents (leave empty to keep the quote open, 0 for an explicitly free service), the currency, the tax note, the terms version, the validity and the cancellation policy. Press **Send scope**; the requester is notified without the price in the email. Each scope is a new numbered version.
5. Once a scope is accepted the **Engagement** section appears. **Assign reviewer**: search and choose; only qualified reviewers (an approved workplace review credential and the reviewer permission) are offered, and the platform refuses anyone else.
6. **Propose meeting times**: one to three start times of the service's duration in your zone. The requester books one.
7. **Cancel engagement** cancels the meeting and ends the reviewer's access; the organisation's results do not change.

For the workplace reviewer

1. Open **Workplace reviews** in the admin app. You see the engagements assigned to you and nothing else.
2. Open an engagement. **Shared results** shows the protected aggregate the organisation shared, with the same hidden cells they see; nothing identifies a respondent. "The organization has not shared results yet, or withdrew the sharing" means you have no access right now.
3. **Report**: write the five sections in your own words: context, reviewed evidence, findings, uncertainties, prioritized proposals. Nothing is prepopulated from a score. **Save draft** as often as you like; a section that is not valid is named with the reason.
4. **Submit for review** when a colleague should read it; **Share with the organization** when it is ready. Sharing releases this version to the requester and cannot be undone; later edits create a new version.
5. **Internal notes** are your working notes. They are never shared and never part of a report.
6. **Propose an action**: title, description, how it will be checked and optionally a dimension. The organisation decides what becomes an agreed action.
7. **Plan follow-up** with a target date (and optionally an owner), then **Complete engagement** when the work is done. Completion is independent of the survey colour; an area may stay red.